

Editorial Standard — PCI Publication Framework

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PROJECT CONTROLS INSTITUTE GLOBAL, INC.

[AI proposes. The professional disposes.](#)

— About this document

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Examples. All worked examples are illustrative and fictional. Figures are chosen to demonstrate a method, not to describe any real project, organisation or market. Sample examination items, where they appear, are study material maintained separately from any live examination bank.

Completeness. Passages marked **[CONFIRM: ...]** are operational or market facts that have not yet been confirmed from a cited source. A document carrying them is a working draft and is not approved for publication.

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Binding on every one of the 100 documents. A subset of [docs/books/EDITORIAL_CHARTER.md](#), tuned for short-form public documents that must survive being read by a hostile expert on LinkedIn.

— 1. Voice

Professional international **British English**. Complete sentences. Active voice where it reads better. Confident where we have grounds, qualified where we do not.

Write for a competent practitioner who is short of time and long on scepticism. Assume they have seen consultancy fluff before and will close the tab the moment they smell it.

The test every document must pass: would a senior project controls manager learn something they could apply this month, and would they be unable to find it stated this clearly anywhere else?

— 2. Prohibited moves

These are rejection-at-gate defects, not style preferences.

Prohibited	Why
Generic AI-shaped openings — "In today's fast-paced project environment..."	Signals nothing was thought about
Motivational filler — "unlock your potential", "take it to the next level"	We teach; we do not cheerlead
Unsupported superlatives — "the world's leading", "industry-standard" (of ourselves)	Claims we have not earned
Bullet lists where prose is clearer, or bullets of one word	Bullets are for genuinely parallel items
Unexplained acronyms on first use	EOT, CBS, QSRA and the rest are expanded once, then used
Constant references to "the exam" in teaching documents	Teaching stands on its own merit
Fabricated quotations, case studies, company names, project data	Absolute prohibition, no exceptions
Invented statistics, salary figures, adoption percentages	See §4
Implying endorsement by a standards body, employer or vendor	Absolute prohibition
™ or ® symbols in PCI branding	Current platform policy
Repetition of the same definition across documents in a series	Define once, cross-reference after
A closing paragraph that only summarises what was just said	End on the consequence, not a recap

— 3. Structure and length

Every document follows `DOCUMENT-TEMPLATE.md`. Beyond that:

- **Best Practice Guides (S09)** — 2,000–3,500 words. At least one fully worked numerical example and one "how this goes wrong" section.
- **Guides and frameworks (S02, S03, S07)** — 1,500–3,000 words.
- **Governance documents (S04, S05, S06)** — as long as completeness requires; clauses numbered for citation.
- **Templates (S10)** — the template is the deliverable. Short instructional preamble, then the structure itself, then completion notes and a worked fragment.
- **Executive summaries (S01)** — 800–1,500 words. Density is the point.

Length is an output check, never a writing method. Padding is a rejection defect.

— 4. Evidence and claims

Four kinds of statement, and each is marked so the reader knows which they are reading:

1. **Fact** — verifiable, and where it matters, cited. Standards are named (IFRS 15, IAS 37, ISO 31000, PMBOK, AACE TCM, the Scrum Guide) and their principles explained **in our own words**. Never reproduce protected text, tables, diagrams or question banks.
2. **Recommended practice** — what the Institute advises, stated as advice.
3. **Professional judgement** — where competent practitioners legitimately differ. Say so, and give the grounds for choosing.
4. **PCI interpretation** — our position, labelled as ours.

Never invent: standards, clause numbers, laws, company facts, project data, quotations, citations, survey results, salary bands, market sizes, adoption rates.

Placeholders. Any operational or market number not yet confirmed is written as `[CONFIRM: what is needed]`. A document may ship to review with placeholders; it may not ship to publication with them. See `README.md` §4.

Illustrative figures. Worked examples are the backbone of our teaching and are always permitted. Label them: "Illustrative figures." A reader must never mistake a teaching example for market data or for a real project.

— 5. Arithmetic discipline

Every number in a worked example is independently verified before submission.

- State units, currency, period and rounding.
- Show the substitution, not just the result: $CPI = EV \div AC = 2,200,000 \div 2,090,000 = 1.053$.
- Currency-neutral where possible. Where a currency is needed, use a generic unit or state the currency explicitly; never imply a jurisdiction's tax or accounting treatment is universal.

- Percentages: state the base. "12 % over" is meaningless without "of what".
- If a calculation depends on an assumption, name the assumption in the same breath as the answer.

A document containing an unverified calculation is rejected at gate.

— 6. Jurisdiction and neutrality

Globally applicable, cross-industry, jurisdiction-neutral. Where legal, tax or accounting treatment varies, say that it varies and describe the principle rather than one country's rule. Where an example needs a legal frame, state the frame as an assumption of the example.

— 7. Cross-referencing

Documents in this framework form a library, not a pile.

- Reference sibling documents by ID and title: see *BPG-09 – Estimate at Completion*.
 - The `related:` front-matter field lists every document a reader should go to next.
 - Where a topic is owned by another document, link rather than restate. Duplication across documents is a defect.
 - The Body of Knowledge ([docs/bok/](#)) is cited by domain: BoK Domain 6 (EVM/EAC).
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— 8. Accessibility

- Tables have header rows and are readable linearly.
 - Every figure or diagram carries a caption and alt text.
 - No meaning is carried by colour alone.
 - Headings are properly nested — never skip a level for visual effect.
 - Plain-language summary at the top of every document (the template's In one paragraph block).
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— 9. LinkedIn adaptation

Every document carries a `linkedin:` block in its front matter with a hook and format. The adaptation rules — how a 3,000-word guide becomes a 200-word post without becoming a lie — are in [LINKEDIN-PLAYBOOK.md](#). Two rules bind here:

1. **The post must be true on its own.** A hook that only works because the reader has not yet read the caveat is a defect.
 2. **The teaching goes in the post, not behind the click.** We publish; we do not tease.
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— 10. Per-document checklist

Before a draft is submitted:

- [] Front matter complete and schema-valid ([FRONT-MATTER-SCHEMA.md](#))
- [] Template sections all present, in order
- [] Opens on substance — no throat-clearing paragraph
- [] Every calculation independently verified, substitutions shown
- [] Every unconfirmed number is a [\[CONFIRM: ...\]](#) placeholder
- [] Illustrative examples labelled as illustrative
- [] No fabricated source, quotation, company, project or statistic
- [] Standards named, explained in our own words, never reproduced
- [] Acronyms expanded on first use
- [] No duplication of a sibling document's owned topic
- [] [related:](#) populated with real IDs that exist in the registry
- [] LinkedIn hook is true standing alone
- [] British English throughout; no [™]/[®] in PCI branding
- [] Closes on a consequence, not a summary